

LOCK n LOAD LINUX

You just set up your Linux box, and think you're finally safe; well, think again.

Use these standard tools to secure it



Arvind Chandrasekar laughs as he says, "If you don't like someone, just start packeting them...happened to me, many times over...". Chandrasekar has really good reasons to secure his network. Business development manager for AMD Far East, long time IRC user and a techie to the core, his many computers at home and a fat pipe to the Internet has made him a favourite target of cranks and phreaks. Even as we speak to him, he's being packeted, but he isn't worried; his stripped-down Debian Linux-based 386 provides him with enough protection.

Protection, of course, is key. When you go online, don't think of doing so without adequate protection. You might think a Linux box is immune to the nasties of the world, but there'll always be people ready to come and probe your computer, and use your network resources—it's like getting mugged in a dark alley.

The only way to make your computer truly secure is to stay off the Net, and even your LAN. But don't worry—we're here to help you avoid such drastic measures. We loaded up Red Hat Linux 9 on a test rig, used the default installation options, and configured it to connect to our LAN and to the Internet.